

TOPIC 4: 1896 Philippine Revolution

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Introduction for the 1896 Philippine Revolution

As the Philippines enter the last decade of the 19th century, the tension between the Filipinos and the Spaniards that have been long ignored is slowly taking hold of public consciousness. This was largely in part because of the efforts of Filipino propagandists in Europe. However, while the Propaganda Movement slowly loses momentum with its failure to produce tangible reforms in the colony there was a growing number of the Filipinos who were drawn towards the idea of independence. On the day of Jose Rizal's exile to Dapitan on July 7, 1892, a revolutionary organization was formally established – the Kataastaasan Kagalanggalang Katipunan ng mga Anak ng Bayan. And in 1896, the Katipunan, under the guidance of Andres Bonifacio, spearheaded the revolution against Spain with the goal of gaining independence.

The selected documents trace the history of the 1896 Philippine Revolution from the establishment of the Katipunan up to the creation of a revolutionary government under Emilio Aguinaldo in June 1898. Most of the materials account for the crucial parts of the Revolution by exploring the official documents of the Katipunan, the personal correspondences of Andres Bonifacio, and the autobiography of Gregoria de Jesus. It also includes the Acta de la Proclamación de Independencia del Pueblo Filipino and the Decree of June 23, 1898 which both reflects the continuing struggle for independence and recognition by the Filipino revolutionists.

“Acta de la Proclamación de Independencia del Pueblo Filipino” (Declaration of Philippine Independence) written by Ambrosio Rianzares Bautista

Source: Gregorio F. Zaide, ed., *Documentary Sources of Philippine History*, vol. 9 (Metro Manila: National Bookstore, Inc., 1990), pp. 235-241.

Ambrosio Rianzares Bautista, born in Biñan, Laguna in 1830, was a lawyer and an adviser to General Emilio Aguinaldo. He accomplished his basic education in Laguna before transferring to Manila in order to study law at the University of Santo Tomas. According to the National Historical Commission of the Philippines (NHCP), Bautista was a distant relative of Dr. Jose Rizal who often called him “Tio Bosyong.” Before the outbreak of the 1896 Philippine Revolution, he was a known supporter of the Propaganda Movement’s campaign for reforms. Under the context of the war, Bautista assumed the roles of political adviser and war auditor for Aguinaldo’s revolutionary government.

The “Acta de la Proclamación de Independencia del Pueblo Filipino” or simply the Act of the Declaration of Philippine Independence was a document penned by Bautista in his capacity as advisor to Aguinaldo. The independence document was read by him before a crowd who attended the ceremony on 12 June 1898 in Kawit, Cavite. Most interestingly, it was Bautista and not Aguinaldo who waved the Philippine flag, according to the NHCP. The document was signed by 98 individuals including an American colonel named L.M. Johnson who served as witness to the event. The Act of the Declaration of Philippine Independence cited in this file is an English translation most probably provided by the historian, Gregorio F. Zaide.

In the town of Cavite Viejo, in this province of Cavite, on the twelfth day of June eighteen hundred and ninety-eight, before me, Don Ambrosio Rianzares Bautista, Auditor of War and Special Commissioner appointed to proclaim and solemnize this act by the Dictatorial Government of these Philippine Islands, for the purposes and by virtue of the circular addressed by the Eminent Dictator of the same Don Emilio Aguinaldo y Famy, the undersigned being assembled, among whom figure commanders of his army and the representatives of others who have not been able to attend and notable residents of various towns of the same, taking into consideration that their inhabitants being already weary of bearing the ominous yoke of Spanish domination, on account of the arbitrary arrests and harsh treatment practised by the Civil Guard to the extent of causing death with the connivance and even with the expressed orders of their commanders, who sometimes went to the extreme of ordering the shooting of prisoners under the pretext that they were attempting to escape, in violation of the provisions of the Regulations of their Corps, which abuses were unpunished on account of the unjust deportations, especially those decreed by General Blanco, of eminent personages and of high social position, at the

instigation of the Archbishop and the friars interested in keeping them out of the way for their own and avaricious purposes, deportations which were quickly brought about by a method of procedure more execrable than that of the Inquisition and which every civilized nation rejects on account of a decision being rendered without a hearing of the persons accused, the people determined to start an insurrectionary movement in August, eighteen hundred and ninety-six, for the purpose of recovering the independence and sovereignty of which Spain deprived them through the Adelantado Miguel Lopez de Legazpi, who continuing the course followed by his predecessor Fernando de Magallanes, who arrived upon the shores of Cebu and occupied that Island by virtue of the treaty of friendship which he celebrated with its King Tupas, although he was killed on the battle which took place on said shores, to which he was provoked by King Kalipulako de Maktan, who was suspicious of his bad intention; he landed on the Island of Bohol, entering also into the celebrated blood compact of friendship with its King Sikatuna, for the purpose, after taking Cebu by force of arms, because the successor of Tupas did not permit him to occupy it, of coming to Manila, the capital, as he did, likewise winning the friendship of King Soliman and Lakandula and afterwards taking possession of it and thus the entire Archipelago for Spain, by virtue of an order of King Philip II; that in view of these historical data, because in international law the prescription established by the laws legalizing even the fraudulent acquisition of the property of individuals is not recognized, there can be no doubt as the legality of such a movement as the one that was quieted but not entirely quenched by the pacification proposed by Pedro A. Paterno with Don Emilio Aguinaldo as President of the Republican government established in Biak na bato, and accepted by the Governor General, Don Fernando Primo de Rivera, under conditions which were established, some in writing and others verbally, among them a general amnesty for all deported and sentenced; that by reason of nonfulfillment of some of these conditions after the destruction of the Spanish squadron by the North American force and the bombardment of Cavite, Don Emilio Aguinaldo returned to start a new revolution, and hardly had he given the word to commence, on the thirty-first of the last month, when several towns anticipated movement, and on the twenty-eight between Imus and Cavite Viejo there was an engagement and captured a Spanish force one hundred and seventy-eight, commanded by a major of marine infantry. This movement spread like an electric spark through the other towns not only in this province, but also in Bataan, Pampanga, Batangas, Bulacan, Laguna, and Moron, some of them with seaports. So complete is the triumph of our arms, truly marvelous and unparalleled in the history of colonial revolutions, that in the first province there remain to be surrendered only the detachments of Naic and Indang; in the second there are none at all, in the third, resistance by the Spanish forces is localized in the town of San Fernando, where the greater part are concentrated, the remainder being in Macabebe, Sexmoan and Guagua; in the fourth only in the city of Lipa; in the fifth, in the capital and Calumpit; and in the remaining two, only in their respective capitals. The city of Manila will soon be completely besieged by our forces, and also the posts in the provinces of Nueva Ecija, Tarlac, Pangasinan, La Union, Zambales, and several others in the Visayan islands, where insurrection has broken out in several of their towns, having started in some almost at the moment of completing that pacification, and in others even before that, wherefore the independence of our territory and the recovery of our sovereignty are assured. And summoning as a witness of the rectitude of our intentions, the Supreme Judge of the Universe, and under the protection of the mighty and

humane North American Nation, we proclaim and solemnly declare, in the name and by the authority of the inhabitants of all these Philippine Islands, that they are and have the right to be free and independent; that they are released from all obedience to the crown of Spain; that every political ties between the two is and must be completely severed and annulled; and that, like all free and independent states, they have complete authority to make war, conclude peace, establish treaties of commerce, enter into alliances, regulate commerce, and execute other acts and things that Independent States have the right to do. Reposing firm confidence in the protection of Divine Providence, we mutually pledge for the support of this declaration, our lives, our fortunes and our most sacred possession, which is our honor. We acknowledge, approve and confirm, together with the orders that have been issued therefrom, the Dictatorship established by Don Emilio Aguinaldo, whom we honor as the Supreme Chief of this nation, which this day commences to have a life of its own, in the belief that he is the instrument selected by God, in spite of his humble origin, to effect the redemption of this unfortunate people, as foretold by Doctor Jose Rizal in the magnificent verses which he composed when he was preparing to be shot, liberating them from the yoke of Spanish domination in punishment of the impunity with which their Government allowed to the commission of abuses by its subordinates; and for the unjust executions of said Rizal and others who were sacrificed to please the greedy body of friars in their insatiable desire to seek revenge upon and exterminate all those who are opposed to their Machiavellian purposes, which tramples upon the penal code prescribed for these islands; and for the sake of those persons who, though merely suspected, were convicted by the commanders of detachments at the instigation of the friars without form or semblances of a trial and without the spiritual consolation afforded by our sacred religion; and likewise for the execution for the same motives of the eminent native Filipino priests Doctor Jose Burgos, Mariano Gomez, and Jacinto Zamora, whose innocent blood was shed through the intrigues of those so-called religious orders which pretended that a military insurrection had broken out on the night of January 21st, 1872, in the Fort of San Felipe in the town of Cavite, accusing said martyrs of starting it, so as to prevent the execution of the decree-sentence issued by the Council of State in the appeal in administrative litigation interposed by the Secular Clergy against the Royal Orders wherein it was directed that the parishes under them in the jurisdiction of this Archbishopric should be turned over to the Recoletos in exchange for those controlled by the Recoletos in Mindanao, which were transferred by the Jesuits. These revoked completely, and the return of those parishes was ordered. The papers were filed in the Colonial Department, to which they were sent some the last months of the preceding year, for the preparation of the respective Royal Provision. That was what caused the tree of Liberty to bud in this land of ours, the iniquitous measures employed to suppress it only causing it to grow more and more, until, the last drop having been drained from the cup of our afflictions, the former insurrection broke out at Caloocan, extended to Santa Mesa, and continued its course to the adjoining places in this province, where the unequalled heroism of its inhabitants met with failure in the battles with General Blanco, and continued to struggle against the great hosts of General Polavieja for the period of three months, without any of the war material that we now possess, but commencing with arms peculiar to the country, such as the bolo, sharpened bamboo, and arrow. Moreover, we confer upon our renowned Dictator, Don Emilio Aguinaldo, all the powers necessary for the due administration of his Government, including the prerogatives of pardon and amnesty. And finally,

it was unanimously resolved that this Nation, independent from this day, must use the same flag used heretofore, whose design and colors are described in the accompanying drawing, with design representing in natural colors the three arms referred to. The white triangle represents the distinctive emblem of the famous Katipunan Society, which by means of its compact of blood urged on the masses of the people to insurrection; the three stars represent the principal Islands of this Archipelago, Luzon, Mindanao, and Panay, in which this insurrectionary movement broke out; the sun represents the gigantic strides that have been made by the sons of this land on the road of progress and civilization, its eight rays symbolizing the eight provinces of Manila, Cavite, Bulacan, Pampanga, Nueva Ecija, Bataan, Laguna and Batangas, which were declared in a state of war almost as soon as the first insurrectionary movement was initiated; and the colors blue, red and white commemorate those of the flag of the United States of North America, in manifestation of our profound gratitude towards that Great Nation for the disinterested protection she is extending to us and will continue to extend to us. And grasping said flag, I displayed it to the assemblage, and all swore solemnly to recognize it and defend it to the last drop of our blood. In witness whereof, I commit the proceedings in writing in this act, which is signed with me by all those concurring in this act, as well as by the only foreigner a North American subject, Mr. L.M. Johnson, Colonel of Artillery, who attended the meeting, to all of which I certify.

(Signed) AMBROSIO RIANZARES BAUTISTA

The declaration of Artemio Ricarte (dated 24 March 1897) concerning the Tejeros Convention

Source: Jim Richardson, *The Light of Liberty: Documents and Studies on the Katipunan, 1892-1897* (Quezon City: Ateneo de Manila University Press, 2013), pp. 342-346.

Artemio Ricarte, known by his *nom de guerre* “Vibora,” was one of the high-ranking generals of the Katipunan during the course of the 1896 Philippine Revolution. Ricarte was born in Batac, Ilocos Norte in 1866 where he began his formal schooling. Eventually, he transferred to Manila for his tertiary education at Collegio de San Juan de Letran. Before the outbreak of the revolution, he was initiated into the secret society and eventually rose through the ranks as treasurer for Balangay ng mga Anak Bayan Mapagtiis (a Katipunan chapter in San Francisco de Malabon, Cavite where he settled). When the revolution commenced, Ricarte became a commander in one of the earliest military encounters against the Spanish forces in Cavite – the Battle of San Francisco de Malabon. During the Tejeros Convention on 22 March 1897, he was elected by his peers as the Captain-General of the revolutionary government.

The declaration of Ricarte is an important document that provides a glimpse into the politics of the revolution as evidenced in the events of the Tejeros Convention. Here, Ricarte writes his reluctance to participate in an oath-taking ceremony at Tanza the day after the controversial convention. He thinks that he was obligated to attend the ceremony due to the presence of high-ranking Magdiwang officials from various towns in Cavite. In *The Revolt of the Masses: The Story of Bonifacio and the Katipunan* (1956), Teodoro A. Agoncillo (pp. 221-222) cites Ricarte’s revealing views about the drama in Tejeros: “This premature oath-taking will cause serious trouble and misunderstanding among the revolutionists, for I myself witnessed all that transpired in Tejeros.” The declaration of Ricarte in this file has an English translation provided the historian, Jim Richardson.

Ako si Artemio Ricarte “Vibora” may katampatang taong, taga bayan ng Batak, lalauigan ng Hukuman ng Ilocos Norte, kapatid sa K.K.K. ng mga A.N.B., at tumatahan dito sa Mapagtiis o Malabon sakop ng S.B. Magdiuang o Noveleta, ay nagsasaysay ng boong katotohanan at hanggang sa labi ng hukay ay aking haharapan.

Na sa oras na ikaanim ng hapon kahapon alinsunod sa isang liham sarinlan na kalakip nito, ay sumapit ako sa Convento ng bayan ng Tanza o Panguagui, at nadatnan ko ang Kgg. na Dakilang G. Emiliano Riego de Dios, Ministro de Fomento, at Kgg. na Dakilang G. Mariano Trias, Ministro de Gracia y Justicia ng S.B. Magdiuang, pati G. Santiago Rillo, Vicente Riego de Dios,

at iba't iba pang Guinoo sa bayan bayang nasasakupan nitong nasabing S.B.; at gayon din na nadatnan ko ang ilang Matataas na G. Pinuno sa S.B. Magdalo, at sa pagdating ko, ay namasdang kong nakahanda ang isang Crucifijo sa guitna ng Antesala ng nasabing Convento; at ang mga G. Pinunong nabangguit na, ay kapagkaraka'y nagsabi ng kadahilanan ng pagkahiling nila na ako'y humarap doon, at ualang ibang dahil, kundi ang pagtanggap sa pamamagitan ng isang panunumpa sa harapan ng Crucifijo at sa masid ng kalahatan o ilang bayan, ng katungkulan pagka Pangulong Digma ng Katagalugan, ayon sa kinalabasan ng pagkapulong ng arao na ika 22 nitong lumalakad na buan; sa bagay na ito, ay ipinakita ko muli sa kalahatang naroroon, ang malaking kaayaoan kong tumanggap ng naturang katungkulan sa mga kadahilanang sumusunod:

Una- Aking pinasasalamatan ang paglabas ko sa paghalal na ito, na maging Pangulong Hukbo ng buong Katagalugan; datapua kinikilala kong may karumihan o kalabuan ang pagkaparaan ng pagkahalal sa akin; sapagkat napaguari ko na hindi nasunod ang tunay na kalooban ng mga taong bayan at;

Ikalaua – Iginagalang ko ang naturang katungkulan, at natatalastas ko ang kaniyang kalakhan at kapangyarihan; at gayon din na natatakot ako ang buong aking nakakayanan sa lahat ng bagay, na lubhang kulang na kulang at maliit na maliit sa dahilang ito, natalos at napagkilala ko ang di ko karapatan; sa lahat ng ito, at hindi maaamin ng konsiyensiya ko ang pagtanggap ng nasabing katungkulan: Gayon ang unang isinagot ko sa mga G. at mga taong bayang naroroon na sari saring pinagbuhatan, na aking nakaharap sa Convento at nagpatalastas sa akin ng pagsumpa sa pagtanggap sa gabing yaon ng nasabing katungkulan.

Ako'y nagsabi rin na kung sa gabing ito'y maghahandog ng panunumpa sa pagtanggap na nasabi ng katungkulan, ay hindi ako makakaayon, dahil

Una -- Sa uala sa Kapulungan ang mga karamihang pinunong humarap sa paghahalal, lalung lalo na ang President ng pagkapulong sa nasabing oras na ika 22 nitong lumalakad na buan;

Ikalaua -- Sa pagkatanto ko na kung ito'y gagauin, siya ang pagmumulan ng malaking kaguluhan at hindi ipagkakaisa ng mga bayan bayan, anupa't ipinahalata ko sa kalahatan ang totoong hindi pag ayon, hanggang sa ako'y humingi sa kaginoohan at sa taong bayan, ng dalauang bagay:

Patayin ako sa oras ng gabing yaon, sa kadahilanang nasasabi sa itaas na ito o bigyan ako ng tatlong oras na pahintulot o isang oras kaya at ng mapag isip ko ang mga bagay bagay na nararapat sa pagtanggap ng nasabing katungkulan; itong ikalauang bagay na hiniling ko, ay

ginagaua kong paraan lamang, upang makaalis ako sa Kapulungang yaon. Ang lahat na aking hiniling, ay ualang nangyari, sapagka't ualang umayon ni kahit isa man lamang; sa madaling salita, sa himok at pag amu amo'y kalahatan sa pamamagitan ng Kgg. na Dakilang G. Emilio Aguinaldo, Pangulong Digma ng S.B. Magdalo, na sa oras ng ikauulo ng gabi, ay naghandog ng panunumpa, ang Kgg. na Dakilang G. Mariano Trias, Ministro de Gracia y Justicia ng S.B. Magdiwang bagaman, aking mauulit, na hindi maaamin ng aking kalooban, sa oras na ikaisa ng hatinggabing yaon, ay naghandog din ako ng panunumpa ng pagtanggap ng katungkulang pagka Pangulong Hukbo ng buong Katagalugan.

Ito ang buong katotohanan na kailanma'y hindi ko matatalikdan kaya't sa arao na ito ika 24 ng buan ng Marzo ng taong isang libo, ualong daan, siam na put pito, ay linagdaan ko ng tunay kong pangalan, apellido at pamagat na tinataglay.

G. Artemio Ricarte

Vibora

[ENGLISH TRANSLATION]

I, Artemio Ricarte "Vibora", of legal age, of the town of Batak in the provincial jurisdiction of Ilocos Norte, a brother of the K.K.K. ng mga A.N.B. and residing here at Mapagtiis or Malabon, under the jurisdiction of the S.B. Magdiwang or Noveleta, declare the following to be the whole truth that I shall maintain to the grave.

That at six o'clock yesterday afternoon, in conformity with the attached letter [see below], I went to the convento of the town of Tanza or Panguagui and there I found the Honorable Don Emiliano Riego de Dios, Minister of Development, and the Honorable Don Mariano Trias, Minister of Grace and Justice of the S.B. Magdiwang, together with Srs. Santiago Rillo, Vicente Riego de Dios, and other gentlemen from the towns under the jurisdiction of the said S.B., and likewise I found various high chiefs of S.B. Magdalo. Upon my arrival I noticed that a crucifix had been prepared in the center of the hall of the said convento; and the aforementioned chiefs thereupon informed me of the reason why they had requested my presence there, which was none other than that I should take an oath of office, before the crucifix and watched by people from all or some of the towns, as President of War of Katagalugan, in conformity with the outcome of the convention held on the 22nd of the current month. In this regard I again stated to all those present there my great reluctance to accept said office for the following reasons:-

First - That I appreciated having been elected President of War of all Katagalugan in this election, but that I recognized there had been dirty or shady practices in the manner of my election, because I understood that it had not been in conformity with the true will of the people.

Second - That I respected the said office and realized its importance and authority; and that I was fearful in all respects about my abilities. I considered myself very deficient and inadequate, and recognized that I did not have the necessary competence, and that on account of all this I could not in good conscience accept the said office. This was my first reply to the gentlemen and other people present there, from various places, whom I met at the convento, and who advised me that I must take the oath of office that very night.

I also stated that if the oath of said office was to be administered that very same night I could not agree, because:

First - The majority of the chiefs present at the election, and especially the President of the convention held at the said time, the 22nd of the present month, were absent from the Assembly.

Second - I knew that if this was done, it would cause much disturbance and discord in the towns; in short, I gave them all to understand that I strongly disagreed, to the extent that I requested of the gentlemen and the townspeople two things:

That they kill me that same night, for the reasons above cited, or that they give me three hours, or at least one hour, to think over what I must necessarily do in order to accept said office; this second request was but a mere pretext, in order to enable me to absent myself from that Assembly. I obtained nothing of what I requested, because not even one of them gave me his assent. To be brief, at the request and supplication of all, His Excellency Don Emilio Aguinaldo, President of War of S.B. Magdalo, took the oath at about eight o'clock in the evening, together with His Excellency Mariano Trias, Minister of Grace and Justice of S.B. Magdiwang, and though, I again repeat, I could not in good conscience accept it, I also took the oath as President of War of all Katagalugan, at about one o'clock that night.

This is the whole truth which I shall never be able to retract, hence, on this day the 24th of the month of March, of the year one thousand, eight hundred and ninety-seven, I sign my real name, surname and the alias I bear.

Don Artemio Ricarte

Vibora

“Andres Bonifacio’s Letter to Julio Nakpil, February 13, 1897”

Source: Richardson, Jim. “Andres Bonifacio, Letter to Julio Nakpil, February 13, 1897.” Last modified 2018. <http://www.kasaysayan-kkk.info/cavite-politics-in-a-time-of-revolution/andres-bonifacio-letter-to-julio-nakpil-february-13-1897>

Bonifacio’s letter to Julio Nakpil provides a glimpse to the internal affairs of the Katipunan. Two interesting matter arose from the document. The first one is one the subject of an imprisoned Augustinian friar by the name of Antonio Piernavieja who was being held captive. And the second subject is on the copy of the “Himno Nacional” which Nakpil sent to Bonifacio.

The matter regarding Piernavieja, details how he was being treated in Bonifacio’s camp. Richardson noted that there seems to be an ongoing negotiation for Piernavieja’s released should a reasonable sum be paid. Regarding the matter of the “Himno Nacional,” Richardson noted that Nakpil composed this upon the request of Bonifacio when they were still encamped in Balara in the late months of 1896.

Andres Bonifacio’s Letter to Julio Nakpil, February 13, 1897

[Tagalog text]

Sa Kap... na M. Julio Nakpil Guiliw, Pangulo ng M. na Sangunian sa bayan ng Pasig.

Guiliw kong kapatid: tinangap ko po rito ang iniyong kalatas gawa ng ika 30 ng Enerong nagdaan, at sa pagkatanto ng doo’y iniyong saad, ay ang tugon ko’y ang sumusunod.

Ako po ay tumangap ng sulat niniyo na dalawang veces na at aking sinagot naman, nguni’t ang di malaman ay kun tinangap niniyo, бага man aquing ipinaaalaala na ang sagot ng huli ay saloob na ng buang ito.

Kalakip ng kalatas niniyo na sinasagot ko, na dumating sa akin ng ika [blank] ng lumalakad, ay tinangap ko ang Himno Nacional at susundin ang tanging hiling sainiyo ukol dito.

Ang Fraileng si Antonio Piernavieja ay mabute at kalakip na ipinadadala ko sa iniyo upang gawin ang nararapat, ang sulat ng nasabing Fraile sa kaniyang anak na ibinabalita ang kaniyang kalagayan at tuloy sinasabi na siya ang may nasa na maabuloy sa atin. Ayon dito sa abuloy na ito at sa sabi niniyo na ang anak na iyan ay ayos sa atin at makaabuloy ng halagang \$1000; sa akala ko ay makahihingi tayo ng \$5000 – limang libong piso, sapagka sa balita ko ay

may kualtang maraming hindi niya lubos ipagdadamdang ang halagang ito; kaya ka yo ang bahalang tumapon. Masasaghe niniyo tuloy sa anak niya ang kaniyang amo ay hindi mapapatay na at dili naman pahihirapan, sapagka ipinagutos ko na taga ingat ng bilangguan na huag na siyang papagtrabahuin.

Ako ay lubos nagagalak sa balita inyo tungkol sa kay Grl. Francisco de los Santos, at kun kayo ay susulat sa kaniya ay masabi niniyo ang aking sa kaniya ay pagpupuri.

Mangyare po lamang na kun ano man ang mangyare sa sulat ni Piernavieja sa kanyang anak, ay malaman ko agad.

Ako po at ilang mga taga rian ay may panukala na humagay sa bayang Bakood at ng malapit dian sa atin at ang isapa ay ng doon magawa ang mga paggagayak ng mga kakailanganin sa paguwi namin dian na ito ay di malalaon, sapagka talastas ko na malaking lubha ang kailangan na tayo ay magkapipisan dian.

Ingatan kayong lahat dian ng Maykapal; at tangapin ang yakap na ipinahahatid namin.

Malabon, ika 13 ng Febrero ng 1897.

Ang K. Pangulo

And.: Bonifacio

Maypagasa

[English translation]

To Brother Mr Julio Nakpil, Guiliw, President of the High Council in the town of Pasig.

My brother Guiliw: I have received here your letter written on 30th January last, and, having understood what you say in it, my reply is as follows.

I received your [earlier?] letter twice already, and have also replied, but what I don't know is whether you received it, although I have reminded you to reply to it within the present month.

Together with your letter to which I am now replying, which reached me on the [blank] of the present month, I received the National Hymn and I will comply with the special request that has been made to you in this regard.

The friar Antonio Piernavieja is well, and together with this I am sending you, so that you can do what is necessary, the letter of the said friar to his son giving news of his current situation and going on to say that he has the desire to give us a contribution. In relation to this donation, and to what you said about the son settling with us to contribute the amount of \$1,000: in my opinion we could ask for \$5,000 – five thousand pesos, because my information is that they have lots of money and this amount would not totally overwhelm them; so it is up to you to agree. Then you can go ahead and tell the son that his father will not be killed, nor even suffer hardship, because I have instructed the guards of the prison that he should not be made to work.

I am overjoyed by your news about Grl. Francisco de los Santos, and if you are going to write to him could you tell him that I applaud him.

Whatever happens in relation to the letter of Piernavieja to his son, please can I know as soon as possible.

Myself and some people from there have a plan to position ourselves in the town of Bakood so that we are nearer to there, and one other thing is that it will not take long there for the necessary preparations to be made for our return home, because I appreciate very gravely the need for us to group together there.

May the Creator take care of you all there; and accept the embrace that we send.

Malabon, February 13, 1897

The Supreme President

And.: Bonifacio

Maypagasa

“Andres Bonifacio’s Letter to Emilio Jacinto, April 16, 1897”

Source: Richardson, Jim. *The Light of Liberty: Documents and Studies on the Katipunan, 1892-1897*. Quezon City: Ateneo de Manila University Press, 2013.

Though the revolutionary forces in Cavite succeeded in capturing towns in the province during the first months of the revolution, the rivalry between the Magdalo and Magdiwang faction helped turn the tide in favor of the Spaniards. While Bonifacio hoped that his presence in the province would help remedy the animosity between the two groups such was not the case. A meeting at the estate-house in Tejeros that attempted to create a new government to unify the effort under one banner failed. Bonifacio stormed-out of the convention after an altercation with Daniel Tirona after the latter protested Bonifacio’s election as the Director of Interior.

Andres Bonifacio’s letter to Emilio Jacinto on April 16, 1897 was his first correspondence that recounts what happened during the controversial meeting at Tejeros. It contextualizes the situation in Cavite as the Spanish colonial army captures towns which were previously under the control of the revolutionaries. The letter also details Bonifacio’s sentiment about revolutionary movement in general and the Tejeros convention in particular. In this letter, Bonifacio also expressed his dismay as there have been members of the movement who were traitors to the cause. The letter also made mention of Bonifacio’s plan to spread the revolution outside Manila particularly in Nueva Ecija and Bulacan.

Andres Bonifacio’s Letter to Emilio Jacinto, April 16, 1897

[Tagalog Text]

ANDRES BONIFACIO

MAYPAGASA

P. ng K. Kapulungan

Naik ika 16 ng Abril 1897

M. Emilio Jacinto Pingkian

Kgg. na Pangulong hukbo

Buhat sa mga kaguluhan dito sa pagka pasok ng kalaban sa mga bayan ng Silang, P. Dasmariñas, Bakood, Ymus, Kawit, Noveleta, Malabon, Tansa at Salinas, ay hindi ako bigyang panahun na makasulat sa inyo na sagutin ko ang inyong mga sulat sa akin, gayon mag pinilit kong makasulat diyan at maipadala sa ating Kapatid na si M. Nlltcllñllc Gxqbnrn [Antonino Guevara] na may malaking bagay na sa inyo'y ipagsasabi.

Ang inyong ipinadala dito ay aking tinangap na dalawang tarrong polvora, isang bayong na capsulang walang laman at tatlong pung piso. Sa sulat ay nasasabing limang pu, datapua't ito lamang ang idinating sa akin sa pagka't di umano'y kinuha uli ng Kap. na Nakpil ang dalawang pung piso.

Ang sunod sunod na pagka agaw ng kalaban sa mga bayan ng nasabi sa unahan nito, ay buhat sa kakulangan nang pagkakaisa at pananatili ng dating kaugalian na pag iiringan ng mga pinuno na magpahangan ngayo'y nananatili pa, kahit inaabot na ang mahigpit na kalagayang tinatawid ng bayan.

Dito'y may tinangap na sulat si Capitang Emilio, na padala ng isang Jesuita na nagnangalang Pio Pi at isang Kastila na si Rafael Comenge ng hindi pa na aagaw ang Ymus, doo'y hinihikayat ang mga pinuno ng Revolucion nabigyan na ng hanga itong paglalaban at di umano'y bibigyan tayo ng laganap na kapatawaran. Ang nasabing Capitan Emilio ay mag ginawang Condiciones na ibig na hingin sa kaaway na gaya ng paalisin ang mga fraile, diputados a Cortes at iba pang mga bagaybagay, at itoy ipinahatid sa kay M. Mariano Alvarez at hinihingi ang kanyang pag ayon, itoy isinanguni sa akin at ng hindi namin sang ayunan ay ang ginawa ng taga Ymus, ay sinulatan ng lihim ni Cap. Emilio ang mga Pangulo sa Bayang sakop ng Magdiwang.

Ang Presidente na si M. Mariano sa mapagtalastas ito ay tumawag ng pulong at singuni ang kalooban ng lahat, doo'y pinagkaisahang ipatuloy ang pakikilaban sa Kastila at aagaw ng ano pamang pakikipag-yari. Sa pulong na ito, ay pinagkaisahan na ibangon ang Gobierno ng revolucion; datapuat ang kinalabasan ay gulo, sapagka't natuklasan ng lahat ang daya ng taga Magdalo, kayat nawalang kabuluhan ang pulong na yaon.

Sa mga kaguluhan dito at pagkatalo, ay ang mga tao rito ay nasira ang mga loob, at si Tirona, Kelles, Jose del Rosario na Mtro de guerra, Tte general at director de guerra ay nang si pagprisinta na sa Kastila kasama ng makapal na pinuno at taong bayan na taga Tansa, ito'y taong Magdalong lahat.

Sa mga kataksilang ito na namasdan ng mga kawal ni Capitang Emilio, ang lahat halos (ng mga K) ay naglulumuhod sa akin, na silay ilayas ko na at dalhin diyan sa atin; datapua't hindi ko payagan ito sa pagkat ako'y naaawa sa makapal na taong bayan na walang kasalanan ay siyang aabutin ng katakot takot na pagkaligalig at kamatayan.

Ang mga taga Batangan ay napaiilalim sa kapangyarihan ng K.S. at kumikilala sa ating kapangyarihan at sa makalawa ay sisimulan nila ang pagsalakay sa walong bayan. Sa pagsalakay na ito ay humingi sa akin ng saklolo at pinadalhan ko naman ng dalawang pung barilan at dalawang pung sandatahan at ng umaakay na General ay ang Kapatid na si M. Artemio Ricarte.

Ang bayan ng batangan ay nagtayo na ng isang Gobierno Provincial at ang general nila ay nag ngangalang M. Miguel Malvar, taong matalino at marahil ay mabuti kaysa mga dating kilala nating generales dito sa Tangway.

Kung palarang makuha ang bayan ng Lipa na isa ito walong bayan papasukin, ay doon nila ako inaayayahan lumagay at ng maitawid di umano sa Camarines ang panghihimagsik, kayat sa bagay na ito ibig kong maalaman kung ako'y lalong kailangan diyan ay diyan ako paparian at kung hindi ay dito ako mangangasiwa na.

Kinakailangang totoo ang tayo'y magkaroon ng continuacion sa pag galaw at ng lumaganap na mabuti ang panghihimagsik sa Sangkapuluan, kayat ibig kong mabatid na kung kayo'y nakasapit na sa dakong Bulakan at Nueva Ecija, at kung hindi pa ay magiiwan ako dito ng makapangasiwa at patungo tayo doon; sa pagkat kung hindi tayo kikilos, diya'y batid ninyo, na naririan si Vnvqrtc Llnťñbñdnd [Mamerto Natividad], ay itoy di malayong gawin sa dakong iyan ang ginawa niya ditong paninira sa atin.

Ang armas ay hindi pa dumarating mag pahangang ngayon at ito'y isa pa na nagiging dahil[an] ng aking ikinatitigil dito.

Ang inyong ina ay na sasa Marigundong na kasama ng kanyang kamaganak doon at wala namang ano pamang sakuna ng pinagdadaanan.

Tanggapin ninyo ang aking mahigpit na yakap.

Ang K. Plo.

And.: Bonifacio

Maypagasa

[English translation]

ANDRES BONIFACIO

MAYPAGASA

President of the Supreme Congress

Naik, April 16, 1897

Sr. Emilio Jacinto Pingkian

Most Respected Chief of the Army:-

Due to the turmoil here and the entry of the enemy into the towns of Silang, P. Dasmarinas, Bacoar, Imus, Kawit, Noveleta, Malabon, Tansa and Salinas, I have not had time to write to you in answer to your letters to me. So I shall try hard to write a letter there now, and the bearer will be our brother Don Antonino Guevara, who has most important things to tell you.

I received what you sent me here: two cans of gunpowder, a sackful of empty cartridge shells, and thirty pesos. In the letter it says fifty, but that is all that reached me, because again Brother Nakpil is said to have taken the twenty pesos.

The successive capture of the aforementioned towns by the enemy is due to the unity and resolution that formerly prevailed having now been lost and spurned by the leaders. They maintain that attitude even though the situation befalling the people is dire.

Here Capitan Emilio has received a letter, sent by a Jesuit called Pio Pi and a Spaniard, Rafael Comenge; this was when Imus had not yet been captured. The letter urged the leaders of the Revolution to give up this cause for which we are fighting, and said we would be given an absolute pardon. The said Capitan Emilio set out conditions he wanted to seek from the enemy, like expulsion of the friars, deputies in the Cortes, and other things, and relayed this to Don Mariano Alvarez, requesting his assent. He consulted me, and we did not assent. What the Imus people then did was that Capitan Emilio wrote in secret to the presidents of the towns under the Magdiwang.

President Don Mariano learned of this, and called a meeting and sounded out everyone's feelings. There it was resolved to continue the fight against the Spaniards and to reject any type of reconciliation. At this meeting it was agreed to establish the Government of the revolution, but the outcome was chaos, because everybody discovered the deceit of the Magdalo people, so that meeting lost any significance.

Due to the turmoil here and the defeats, the resolve of people here was broken, and Tirona , Cailles , and José del Rosario , who were Minister of War, Lieutenant-General, and Director of War, surrendered to the Spaniards, and were followed by many leaders and citizens from Tansa; these are all Magdalo people.

Having witnessed this treachery on the part of Capitan Emilio's soldiers, nearly all (the brethren) came to me on their knees asking me to let them get away, and to take them there to our place. But I could not consent to this, because I pity the great number of innocent citizens who would face the most dreadful troubles and slaughter.

The Batangas people are under the authority of the Supreme Council, and recognize our authority. The day after tomorrow they will commence attacks on eight towns. For this offensive they requested my assistance, and so I sent them twenty riflemen and twenty bolomen, and the General in command is Brother Don Artemio Ricarte.

The people of Batangas have already established a Provincial Government. Their general is called Don Miguel Malvar , a very intelligent man, and better, perhaps, than the generals we have so far come to know here in Tangway.

If they have the fortune to take the town of Lipa, which is one of the eight towns to be invaded, they will invite me to base myself there, in order to be able, as they say, to carry the revolution into Camarines. For this reason I wish to know whether I am more needed there, in which case I shall go there; and if not, I shall direct matters here.

It is essential for us to agree on how the resistance should best be continued and the revolution extended throughout the Archipelago. I therefore wish to know whether you have gone yet to Bulacan and Nueva Ecija. If not, I shall leave the directorate here and we shall go there, because if we do not make a move, you know that Mamerto Natividad is there, and before long he will be doing in that place what he did here: slander us.

The arms have not yet arrived up until now, and this is yet another reason that is detaining me here.

Your mother is at Maragondon together with her relative there, and no misfortune whatever has befallen her.

Receive my affectionate embrace.

The Supreme President,

And... Bonifacio

Maypagasa.

Andres Bonifacio, "Katungkulang gagawin ng mga Z. Ll. B." (The "Decalogue"), c. 1896

In 1896, various preparations were made by Andres Bonifacio and the Katipunan for a possible outbreak of the revolution. One of the Supremo's priority was to recruit more members to the underground society. In his aim to propagate the teachings of the Katipunan, Bonifacio wrote the *Decalogue* or *Katungkulang Gagawin ng mga Z. Ll. B.* In this document, the "Father of the Philippine Revolution" outlines the duties of the Katipuneros which include the veneration of God, a high regard for fraternity and patriotism within the society, and a recognition for the need to claim freedom for the country. Since Bonifacio was also a Mason, his *Decalogue* is reminiscent of some of the essential ideals of Freemasonry like reverence to the Creator, as already mentioned. Another Masonic aspect of the document is how it gives value to loyalty amongst brethren, even at the expense of one's life. But what separates Freemasonry from the Katipunan is the latter's aim to liberate the nation from the yoke of colonial oppression. In retrospect, the notion of militancy as a context for Bonifacio's *Decalogue* distinguishes it from its Masonic influence. Bonifacio's *Decalogue* is similar to Emilio Jacinto's *Kartilya* which also contains the teachings of the secret society. In recognition of Jacinto's superior writing style, Bonifacio chose to adopt Jacinto's *Kartilya* as the official document on the teachings of the Katipunan.

Digitized copies of the *Decalogue* are available online on different websites such as the Presidential Museum and Library's digital collections and Jim Richardson's website on the Katipunan (Kasaysayan-kkk.info).

KKK

Katungkulang gagawin ng mga

Z.Ll.B

1. Sumampalataya sa MayKapal ng taimtim sa puso.
2. Gunamgunamin sa sarili tuina, na ang matapat na pag sampalataya sa Kanya ay ang pag ibig sa lupang tinubuan, sa pagkat ito ang tunay na pag ibig sa kapwa.
3. Ykintal sa puso ang pag asa na malabis na kapurihan at kapalaran na kung ikamamatay ng tawoy mag bubuhat sa pagliligtas sa kaalipinan ng bayan.
4. Sa kalamigan ng loob, katiagaan, katuiran at pag asa sa ano mang gagawin nag bubuhat ang ikagaganap ng mabuting ninanais.
5. Paingat ingatang gaya ng puri ang mga bilin at balak ng K.: K.: K.:.
6. Sa isang na sa sapanganib sa pag tupat ng kanyang tungkol, idadamay ng lahat, ang buhay at yaman upang maligtas yaon.

7. Hangarin na ang kalagayan ng isatisa, maging fuaran ng kanyang kapwa sa mabuting pagpapasunod at pag tupad ng kanyang tungkol.
8. Bahaginan ng makakaya ang alin mang nagdaralita.
9. Ang kasipagan sa pag hahanap-buhay ay siyang tunay na pag ibig at pag mamahal sa sarili sa asawa, anak at kapatid o kabayan.
10. Lubos na pag sampalataya sa parusang ilinalaang sa balang sowail at magtaksil, gayon din sa pala na kakamtan ukol sa mabuting gawa. Sampalatayanan din naman na ang mga layong tinutungo ng K. K. K. ay kaloob ng Maykapal, sa makatwid ang hangad ng bayan ay hangad din Nya.

Decree of June 23, 1898, establishing the Revolutionary Government

One of the most significant turning points in the history of the 1896 Philippine Revolution was the Declaration of Independence on 12 June 1898. The establishment of a Dictatorial Government followed the unfurling of the Philippine flag and the proclamation of the Philippine independence six days later. However, Aguinaldo's trusted adviser Apolinario Mabini advised the president that the dictatorial government must be replaced by a revolutionary government. On 23 June 1898, Aguinaldo heeded to the advice of Mabini and he issued a decree establishing the Revolutionary Government. The establishment of the revolutionary government effectively changed the title of Aguinaldo from dictator to President of the Revolutionary Government and Commander-in-chief of its army. The decree contains three chapters. The first chapter contains the provisions on the structure and composition of the revolutionary government. The second chapter contains various provisions on the Revolutionary Congress. The third chapter contains provisions on Military Procedure. The Revolutionary Congress was tasked to draft a constitution for the Republic. On 01 August 1898, the provincial delegates ratified the declaration of Philippine independence to provide legitimacy to the creation of the Revolutionary Congress.

A copy of June 23, 1898 Decree of Emilio Aguinaldo is available at the Presidential Museum and Library's digital archives collection.

DECREE OF JUNE 28, 1898 36

3A. Decree of June 23, 1898, establishing the Revolutionary Government*. (*English translation*)

Don Emilio Aguinaldo y Famy, President of the Revolutionary Government of the Philippines and Commander-in-Chief of its Army.

This Government in its desire to prove to the Filipino people that one of its aims is to combat with firm resolution the inveterate vices of the Spanish administration, replacing its irresponsible and pompous ostentation of doing things with a much more modest, simple and expeditious manner of discharging public functions; I hereby decree the following:

Chapter I

Of the Revolutionary Government

Article 1. The Dictatorial Government shall henceforth be called Revolutionary Government, the object of which is to fight for the Independence of the Philippines until all free nations, including Spain, expressly recognize her, and to prepare the country to become a true Republic.

The Dictator shall henceforth be called President of the Revolutionary Government.

Art. 2. Four Department Secretaryships are hereby created. One of Foreign Relations, Marine and Commerce; another of War and Public Works; another of Police and Internal Peace and Order, Justice, Education and Hygiene; and another of Finance, Agriculture and Industry.

The number of the Department Secretaryships may be increased if it be found that they are inadequate to cope with the multiple and complicated problems of public service.

Art. 3. Each Department Secretaryship shall help the President in the proper discharge of the affairs pertaining to each.

Each Department shall be headed by a Secretary who shall not be responsible for the Decrees issued by the President; however, he shall sign them, with the President, in order to give evidence of their authenticity.

However, if the Decree is issued at the proposal of a Department Secretary, he shall be responsible jointly with the President.

Art. 4. The Department of Foreign Relations shall have 3 Bureaus: one of Diplomacy; another, of Marine; and another, of Commerce.

The first Bureau shall study and direct all those matters pertaining to diplomatic negotiations with foreign powers as well as the correspondence of this Government with them; the second, shall study all mat-

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- Translated from Tagalog by the author.

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tars relating to the creation and organization of our Marine of War and to the necessity of making war expeditions; the third, shall concern itself with internal and external commerce and the execution of commercial treaties with other countries.

Art. 5. The Secretaryship of War shall have 2 Bureaus: one, of War, and another, of Public Works.

The first Bureau shall have 4 Divisions: one, of Campaigns; another of Military Justice; another, of Military Administration; and another, of Military Sanitation.

The Division of Campaigns shall be concerned with the recruitment and screening of those who serve in the Revolutionary Militias; in directing campaigns, drafting of war plans, works of fortifications, and circulation of notices of movements of battles; in the study of military tactics for the Army and the organization of land, artillery, and cavalry forces; and lastly, in the discharge of other matters relating to military campaigns and operations.

The Division of Military Justice shall concern itself with matters relating to military tribunals and trials; in the appointment of jurors and assessors and in the discharge of functions which are juridico-military in nature.

The Division of Military Administration shall take charge of food supplies and other necessities of the Army; and the Division of Military Sanitation shall take charge of matters relating to hygiene and well-being of the militias.

Art. 6. The other Department Secretaryships may have such number of Bureaus, and the Bureaus of such Divisions and Sections as may be necessary, taking into account the nature and importance of the functions embraced.

Art. 7. The Department Secretary shall inspect and supervise the work of his Department and execute the same with the President of the Republic. Each Bureau shall have a Director, and each Division, an official in charge with such number of employees needed.

Art. 8. The President shall choose his Secretaries at his discretion, and in consultation with the latter, appoint all the personnel of the department.

However, in the appointment of employees, favoritism should be eliminated, because the good name of the country and the triumph of the Revolution require the services of truly capable persons.

Art. 9. The Department Secretaries may attend sessions of the Revolutionary Congress whenever they have legislative proposals to submit in the name of the President, or are required to answer some questions from the Representatives; but when their proposals in Congress or

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the object of their appearance therein are to be voted upon, the Secretary concerned must leave, and shall not take part in the voting.

Art. 10. The President of the Government is the personification of the Filipino people, and under this concept, he may not be held liable for his acts during the discharge of his office.

This exemption from liability shall last until the victory of the Revolution is fully attained, unless by reason of extraordinary circumstances he is obliged to present to the Congress his resignation, in which case another suitable person shall be elected in his place.

Chapter II

Of the Revolutionary Congress

Art. 11. The Revolutionary Congress is an Assembly of Representatives from all the provinces of the Philippine Archipelago, elected in the manner provided for in the Decree of June 18 of the current year.

In the provinces which could not elect Representatives due to the fact that the greater portion of the inhabitants thereof have not yet been liberated from the Spanish rule, the Government may

provisionally appoint such number of persons considered most capable by reason of their education and social position, provided they have been born and resided for a long time therein.

Art. 12. The Representatives shall assemble in the town where the Revolutionary Government resides and in such building as this Government may designate, and proceed to do the preliminary work, designating by plurality vote a Commission composed of 5 persons to take charge of giving accreditation of the chosen Representatives, and another Commission of 3 persons who shall examine the documents presented by the aforementioned 5 Commission members.

Art. 13. On the day following, the said Representatives shall re-assemble and the two Commissions shall read their respective reports on the authenticity of the documents examined, resolving by absolute majority vote, those credentials of doubtful authenticity.

Thereafter, by absolute majority vote also, a President, one Vice President, and two Secretaries shall be elected from among the elected Representatives, notifying the Government of the results of the election.

Art. 14. The place of session of the Congress is sacred and inviolable and no armed forces may penetrate into it, unless the President of the same itself so petitions in order to restore order caused by persons who do not know how to honor it and its august functions.

Art. 15. The powers of the Congress are: To work for the general welfare of the Filipino people and to implement the laws of the Revolution; discuss and vote upon said laws; discuss and approve all treaties

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and loans; examine and approve the accounts of general expenses presented annually by the Secretary of Finance as well as all extraordinary contributions and others that may be subsequently imposed.

Art. 16. The Congress shall also be heard in all grave matters which admit of delay or deliberation; but the President of the Government may himself resolve those matters which are urgent in character, without prejudice to informing the Congress of the measures taken by means of a message.

Art. 17. Any Representative may present to Congress any bill; so also, any Department Secretary by order of the President of the Government.

Art. 18. The sessions of Congress shall be public and only in cases which require secrecy shall they be held in secret.

Art. 19. In its deliberations and internal affairs, Congress shall be governed by its own Rules which it may draft. The President shall preside over its deliberations but shall not vote except in case of a tie.

Art. 20. The President of the Government shall not impede nor prevent the holding of sessions by Congress.

Art. 21. Congress shall designate a permanent Commission of Justice presided by the Vice President aided by one of the Department Secretaries and with these and seven others elected by plurality vote, from among the Representatives, shall compose the said Commission.

This Commission shall decide on appeal all criminal cases decided by the provincial councils; and shall have exclusive and original jurisdiction to decide cases filed against Department Secretaries and provincial and municipal officials.

Art. 22. Congress shall keep a Book of Honor wherein shall be noted the names of those who have rendered great service to the country and regarded as such by the said body. Any Filipino, civilian or military, may petition Congress the notation therein of his relevant services supported by documents since the start of the Revolution. For extraordinary services which may arise in the future, the Government at its initiative may propose such notation, justified by the relevant documents.

Art. 23. The Congress shall also, upon the proposal of the Government, grant compensation in cash to families which had become victims of their valor and patriotism in accomplishing acts of heroism.

Art. 24. The grants of Congress shall not be obligatory until the President of the Government orders their compliance and fulfillment. When the said President believes that any congressional grant is uncalled for, he shall oppose its execution, and if the Congress should insist, the President may exercise his veto power for which he alone shall be responsible.

“Kartilya” written by Emilio Jacinto

Source: Jim Richardson, *The Light of Liberty: Documents and Studies on the Katipunan, 1892-1897* (Quezon City: Ateneo de Manila University Press, 2013), pp. 131-137.

Emilio Jacinto, known as the “Brains of the Katipunan,” wrote the “Kartilya” or the “Teachings of the Katipunan” which is considered as one of the essential documents of the secret society. Jacinto was born in Tondo, Manila in 1875 and attended formal schooling at the Collegio de San Juan de Letran before studying law at the University of Santo Tomas. He unfortunately did not finish his law degree after deciding to join the Katipunan when he was 19 years old. Jacinto became one of the highest-ranking officers of the society who assumed the important role of being an advisor to Andres Bonifacio, among other important functions. He is also known as “Pingkian” (his *nom de guerre*) and “Dimasilaw” (his pseudonym).

According to the historian Jim Richardson, the “Kartilya” served as the guiding principles and primary teachings of the Katipunan. The contents of the document explain the primary aspirations of the society and, in turn, the values that were expected from its members. Among the important teachings that the “Kartilya” elaborated were the importance of defending the oppressed, upholding good morals and character, observing equality despite being different in race and socio-economic descent, and respecting women. The “Kartilya” cited in this file has an English translation which Richardson obtained by selecting and combining the translation provided by Teodoro A. Agoncillo and Epifanio de los Santos.

KATIPUNAN

NANG MANGA

A. N. B.

SA MAY NASANG MAKISANIB

SA KATIPUNANG ITO

Sa pagkakailangan, na ang lahat na nagiibig pumasuk sa katipunang ito, ay magkaroon ng lubos na pananalig at kaisipan sa mga layong tinutungo at mga kaaralang pinaiiral, minarapat na ipakilala sa kanila ang mga bagay na ito, at ng bukas makalawa'y huag silang magsisi at tuparing maluag sa kalooban ang kanilang mga tutungkulin.

Ang kabagayang pinaguusig ng katipunang ito ay lubos na dakila at mahalaga; papagisahin ang loob at kaisipan ng lahat ng tagalog () sa pamagitan ng isang mahigpit na panunumpa, upang*

sa pagkakaisang ito'y magkalakas na iwasak ang masinsing tabing na nakabubulag sa kaisipan at matuklasan ang tunay na landas ng Katuiran at Kaliwanagan.

() Sa salitang tagalog katutura'y ang lahat nang tumubo sa Sangkapuluang ito; sa makatuid, bisaya man, iloko man, kapangpangan man, etc., ay tagalog din.*

Dito'y isa sa mga kaunaunahang utos, ang tunay na pag-ibig sa bayang tinubuan at lubos na pagdadamayang ng isa't isa.

Maralita, mayaman, mangmang, marunong, lahat dito'y magkakapantay at tunay na magkakapatid.

Kapagkarakang mapusok dito ang sino man, tataligdan pilit ang buhalhal na kaugalian, at paiilalim sa kapangyarihan ng mga banal na utos ng katipunan.

Ang gawang lahat, na laban sa kamahalan at kalinisan, dito'y kinasusuklaman; kaya't sa bagay na ito ipinaiilalim sa masigasig na pakikibalita ang kabuhayan ng sino mang nagiibig makisanib sa katipunang ito.

Kung ang hangad ng papasuk dito'y ang tumalastas lamang o mga kalihiman nito, o ang ikagiginhawa ng sariling katawan, o ang kilalanin ang mga naririto't ng maipagbili sa isang dakot na salapi, huag magpatuloy, sapagkat dito'y bantain lamang ay talastas na ng makapal na nakikiramdam sa kaniya, at karakarakang nilalapatan ng mabisang gamut, na laan sa mga sukaban.

Dito'y gawa ang hinahanap at gawa ang tinitignan; kaya't hindi dapat pumasuk ang di makagagawa, kahit magaling magsalita.

Ipinauunawa din, ang mga katungkulang ginaganap ng lahat ng napaaanak sa katipunang ito ay lubhang mabibigat lalung lalu na, kung gugunitain na di magyayaring maiiwasan at walang kusang pagkukulang na di aabutin ng kakilakilabot na kaparusahan.

Kung ang hangad ng papasuk dito, ang siya'y abuluyan o ang ginhawa't malayaw na katahimikan ng katawan, huag magpatuloy, sapagkat mabigat na mga katungkulan ang matatagpuan, gaya ng pagtatangkilik sa mga naaapi at madaluhong na paguusig sa lahat ng kasamaan; sa bagay na ito ay aabuting ang maligalig na pamumuhay.

Di kaila sa kangino paman ang mga nagbalang kapahamakan sa mga tagalog na nakaiisip nitong mga banal na kabagayan (at hindi man), at mga pahirap na ibinibigay na nagharing kalupitan, kalikuan at kasamaan.

Talastas din naman ng lahat ang pagkakailangan ng salapi, na sa ngayo'y isa sa mga unang lakas na maaasahang magbibigay buhay sa lahat; sa bagay na ito, kinakailangan ang lubos na pagtupad sa mga pagbabayaran; piso sa pagpasok at sa buan buan ay sikapat. Ang salaping ito'y ipinagbibigay alam ng nagiingat sa tuing kapanahunan, bukod pa sa mapagsisiyasat ng sinoman kailan ma't ibigin. Di makikilos ang salaping ito, kundi pagkayarin ng karamihan.

Ang lahat ng ipinagsaysay at dapat gunitain at mahinahong pagbulaybulayin, sapagkat di magaganap at di matitiis ng walang tunay na pagibig sa tinubuang lupa, at tunay na adhikang ipagtangkilik ang Kagalingan.

At ng lalong mapagtimbang ng sariling isip at kabaitan, basahin ang sumusunod na

MGA ARAL NANG

KATIPUNAN NG MGA A.N.B

Ang kabuhayang hindi ginugugol sa isang malaki at banal na kadahilanan ay kahoy na walang lilim, kundi damong makamandag.

Ang gawang magaling na nagbubuhay sa pagpipita sa sarili, at hindi sa talagang nasang gumawa ng kagalingan, ay di kabaitan.

Ang tunay na kabanalan ay ang pagkakawang gawa, ang pagibig sa kapua at ang isukat ang bawat kilos, gawa't pangungusap sa talagang Katuiran.

Maitim man at maputi ang kulay ng balat, lahat ng tao'y magkakapantay; mangyayaring ang isa'y higtan sa dunong, sa yaman, sa ganda...; ngunit di mahihigtan sa pagkatao.

Ang may mataas na kalooban inuuna ang puri sa pagpipita sa sarili; ang may hamak na kalooban inuuna ang pagpipita sa sarili sa puri.

Sa taong may hiya, salita'y panunumpa.

Huag mong sasayangin ang panahun; ang yamang nawala'y magyayaring magbalik; nguni't panahong nagdaan na'y di na muli pang magdadaan.

Ipagtanggol mo ang inaapi, at kabakahin ang umaapi.

Ang taong matalino'y ang may pagiingat sa bawat sasabihin, at matutong ipaglihim ang dapat ipaglihim.

Sa daang matinik ng kabuhayan, lalaki ay siyang patnugot ng asawa't mga anak; kung ang umaakay ay tungo sa sama, ang patutunguhan ng iaakay ay kasamaan din.

Ang babai ay huag mong tignang isang bagay na libangan lamang, kundi isang katuang at karamay sa mga kahirapan nitong kabuhayan; gamitan mo ng buong pagpipitagan ang kaniyang kahinaan, at alalahanin ang inang pinagbuhata't nagiwi sa iyong kasangulan.

Ang di mo ibig na gawin sa asawa mo, anak at kapatid, ay huag mong gagawin sa asawa, anak, at kapatid ng iba.

Ang kamahalan ng tao'y wala sa pagkahari, wala sa tangus ng ilong at puti ng mukha, wala sa pagkaparing KAHILILI NG DIOS, wala sa mataas na kalagayan sa balat ng lupa; wagas at tunay na mahal na tao, kahit laking gubat at walang nababatid kundi ang sariling wika, yaong may magandang asal, may isang pangungusap, may dangal at puri; yaong di napaaapi't di nakikiapi; yaong marunong magdamdam at marunong lumingap sa bayang tinubuan.

Paglaganap ng mga aral na ito at maningning na sumikat ang araw ng mahal na Kalayaan dito sa kaabaabang Sangkalupuan, at sabugan ng matamis niyang liwanag ang nangagkaisang magkalahi't magkakapatid ng ligaya ng walang katapusan, ang mga ginugol na buhay, pagud, at mga tiniis na kahirapa'y labis nang natumbasan.

Kung lahat ng ito'y mataruk na ng nagiibig pumasuk at inaakala niyang matutupad ang mga tutungkulin, maitatala ang kaniyang ninanasa sa kasunod nito.

[ENGLISH TRANSLATION]

ASSOCIATION

OF THE

SONS OF THE PEOPLE

TO THOSE WHO WANT TO JOIN THIS ASSOCIATION.

In order that all who want to enter this Association may have a full understanding and knowledge of its guiding principles and main teachings, it is necessary to make these things known to them so that they will not, tomorrow or the next day, repent, and so that they may perform their duties wholeheartedly.

This Association pursues a most worthy and momentous object: to unite the hearts and minds of all the Tagalogs () by means of an inviolable oath, in order that this union may be strong enough to tear aside the thick veil that obscures thought, and to find the true path of Reason and Enlightenment.*

*(*The word Tagalog means all those born in this Archipelago; even a person who is a Visayan, Ilocano, or Kapampangan, etc. is therefore a Tagalog too.)*

One of the foremost rules here is true love of the native land and genuine compassion for one another.

Poor, rich, ignorant, wise – here, all are equal and true brethren.

As soon as anybody enters here, he shall perforce renounce disorderly habits and shall submit to the authority of the sacred commands of the Katipunan.

All acts contrary to noble and clean living are repugnant here, and hence the life of anyone who wants to affiliate with this Association will be submitted to a searching investigation.

If the applicant merely wishes to know the secrets of the Association, or to seek personal gratification, or to know who is here in order to sell them for a handful of silver, he cannot proceed, for here the many who are watching him will already know his intentions, and will immediately have recourse to an effective remedy, such as befits traitors.

Here, only actions are demanded and esteemed; hence anybody who is not willing to act should not enter, no matter how good a speaker he might be.

It is also announced that the duties to be performed by the members of this association are exceedingly hard, especially if one remembers that there can be no dereliction or wilful evasion of duty without the exaction of a terrible punishment.

If an applicant merely desires financial support relief or wants to lead a life of bodily comfort and ease, he had better not proceed, for he will encounter weighty tasks, like the protection of the oppressed and the relentless fight against all that is evil. In this way, his fate will be a vexatious life.

Nobody is unaware of the misfortune that threatens the Filipinos who contemplate these things that are sacred (and even those that are not) and the sufferings they are made to endure by the reign of cruelty, injustice and evil.

Everybody also knows the need for money, which today is one of the main things upon which we depend to bring sustenance to all. In this regard, the punctual payment of dues is required: one peso upon entry and then twelve and a half centimos each month. The custodian of the funds will periodically render an account to the members, and each member has a right to examine the accounts, should he so wish. The funds cannot be expended without the consent of the majority.

All this must be thought over and deliberated upon calmly, as it cannot be accomplished or endured by anyone who has no love for his native land and no genuine desire to promote Progress.

And for the upliftment of your mind and virtue, read the following

TEACHINGS OF THE KATIPUNAN OF THE SONS OF THE PEOPLE

A life that is not dedicated to a great and sacred cause is like a tree without a shade, or a poisonous weed.

A good deed lacks virtue if it springs from a desire for personal profit and not from a sincere desire to do good.

True charity resides in acts of compassion, in love for one's fellow men, and in making true Reason the measure of every move, deed and word.

Be their skin dark or pale, all men are equal. One can be superior to another in knowledge, wealth and beauty... but not in being.

A person with a noble character values honor above self-interest, while a person with an ignoble character values self-interest above honor.

An honorable man's word is his bond.

Don't waste time; lost wealth may be recovered, but time lost is lost forever.

Defend the oppressed and fight the oppressor.

An intelligent man is he who takes care in everything he says and keeps quiet about what must be kept secret.

Along the thorny path of life, the man leads the way and his wife and children follow. If the leader goes the way of perdition, then so do those who are led.

Do not regard a woman as a mere plaything, but as a helpmate and partner in the hardships of this existence. Have due regard to her weakness, and remember the mother who brought you into this world and nurtured you in your infancy.

What you would not want done to your wife, daughter and sister, do not do to the wife, daughter and sister of another.

A man's worth does not come from him being a king, or in the height of his nose and the whiteness of his face, or in him being a priest, a REPRESENTATIVE OF GOD, or in his exalted position on the face of this earth. Pure and truly noble is he who, though born in the forest and able to speak only his own tongue, behaves decently, is true to his word, has dignity and honor;

who is not an oppressor and does not abet oppressors, who knows how to cherish and look after the land of his birth.

When these doctrines have spread and the brilliant sun of beloved liberty shines on these poor Islands, and sheds its sweet light upon a united race, a people in everlasting happiness, then the lives lost, the struggle and the suffering will have been more than recompensed.

Andres Bonifacio. “Pag-ibig sa tinubuang bayan.” (c1896)

Sina Andres Bonifacio at Emilio Jacinto ang mga pangunahing tagapaghayag ng simulain at adhikain ng Katipunan. Nababasa sa mga akda nina Bonifacio at Jacinto ang kamalayang pambansa na hinihimok ang mga Pilipino na magkaisa at lumaban para sa kasarinlan at kalayaan. Ilan sa mga kilalang akda ni Bonifacio ang “Hibik ng Filipinas sa Ynang España,” “Ang dapat mabatid ng mga tagalog,” “Katungkulang gagawin ng mga Z.L.B.,” at “Pag-ibig sa tinubuang bayan.” Ang Pag-ibig sa tinubuang bayan” ay nailathala sa Kalayaan ang pahayagan ng lihim na samahang Katipunan. Nailathala noong Marso 1896 ang una at nag-iisang edisyon ng Kalayaan. Sa kasamaang palad, wala pang kopya ng mga pahina ng pahayagan ang natagpuan hanggang sa kasalukuyan. Ang nilalaman ng pahayagan ay mahihinuha mula sa iba’t ibang hiwalay na batis tulad ng mga borador ng artikulo bago ito malimbag.

Ang tulang “Pag-ibig sa tinubuang bayan” ay muling nilathala ni Jose P. Santos, Pilipinong historyador at anak ng isa ring kilalang historyador na si Epifanio de los Santos, noong 1935. Maaaring hinango ito mula sa isang sulat-kamay na borador ng tula at hindi mula sa pahina ng Kalayaan. Kamakailan, isa pang bersyon ng borador ng tula ang natagpuan sa Archivo General Militar de Madrid. Sa isang pag-aaral ni Jim Richardson, pinagkumpara ang dalawang teksto nito upang unawain ang pagkakaiba nito at kilalanin ang tunay na nagsulat nito. Mula sa analisis ng nilalaman, mga salita at ortograpiya ang dalawang bersyon (bersyong Santos at bersyong Madrid), kakaunti lamang ang pagkakaiba sa dalawang borador. Nagpapatunay ito na si Andres Bonifacio nga ang nagsulat ng nabanggit na tula (Richardson 2013, 193-194).

Matutunghayan sa kabuuang 28 saknong na tula ang adhikain at kaisipan na isinusulong ng Katipunan para sa malaya at nagsasariling bansa. Binigyan halaga sa diwa ng metapora ng mag-anak (Inang-Bayan, Anak ng Bayan) ang pagkakaisa ng kapuluan. Malinaw din sa tula ang mga konseptong taal sa kapuluan tulad ng katwiran (katuiran), kaginhawahan (kaguinhawahan) kapatiran at pagkapantay-pantay.

Sa una at huling saknong mababasa ang sumusunod na titik:

(1) Alin pag ibig pa ang hihigit kaya
sa pagka dalisay at pagkadakila
gaya ng pag ibig sa tinubuang lupa?
alin pag ibig pa? wala na nga, wala

(2)

Ipahandog handog ang boong pag-ibig

hanggang sa mga dugo'y ubusing itiguis
kung ang pagtatangol buhay ay [maliit]
itoy kapalaran at tunay na langit.

Andres Bonifacio. “Ang Dapat Mabatid ng mga Tagalog.” (1896).

Isa sa mga akda ni Andres Bonifacio, “Ang Dapat Mabatid ng mga Tagalog” ay nailathala sa pinakauna at nag-iisang isyu ng pahayagang *Kalayaan*, ang opisyal na pahayagan ng Katipunan, noong Marso 1896. Ginamit ni Andres Bonifacio ang sagisag-pangalan na Agapito Bagumbayan nang inilathala ang akdang ito sa *Kalayaan*. Hanggang sa kasalukuyan, hindi pa nakikita at natutuklasan ang kumpletong kopya ng lahat ng pahina ng *Kalayaan*. Nailimbag sa mga hiwalay na akda ang nilalaman ng pahayagan sa mga natuklasang borador at salin ng mga ito. Sa kaso ng “Ang Dapat Mabatid” muling nailathala ito sa wikang Espanyol sa isinagawang salin ni Juan Caro y Mora para sa *Archivo del bibliófilo filipino* ni Wenceslao Retana noong 1897. Isa ring salin nito sa Espanyol ang isinagawa ni Epifanio de los Santos para sa *Revista Filipina* noong 1917. Samantala noong 1935, inilimbag ni Jose P. Santos ang teksto nito sa orihinal na wikang Tagalog bilang bahagi ng kanyang akdang *Andres Bonifacio at ang Himagsikan*. Ipinapalagay na ginamit ni Jose P. Santos ang isang sulat-kamay na borador ng sanaysay na nasa pangangalaga ng kanyang ama na si Epifanio de los Santos. Kilala si Epifanio de los Santos bilang pangunahing tagapangalaga at kolektor ng maraming manuskrito ng Katipunan.

Bagaman may mga pagkakaiba ang mga bersyong nabanggit, naniniwala ang maraming iskolar na ang tekstong Tagalog ni Jose P. Santos na “Ang Dapat Mabatid” ay tunay at hindi huwad na nilikha lamang upang palabasin na akda ito ni Bonifacio.

Kung babasahin “Ang Dapat Mabatid” ito ay may habang higit sa 700-salita at matutunghayan sa sanaysay na ito ang panawagan ni Bonifacio na pukawin ang damdamin at isip ng mga kababayang Pilipino upang lumahok sa Katipunan at humiwalay sa Espanya. Nababasa sa sanaysay na ito ang mga natatanging kaisipan na isinusulong ng Katipunan para sa lahat ng mga Pilipino.

Sa simula ng sanaysay, ipinamalas ni Bonifacio ang malalim na pag-uugat sa kasaysayan ng kilusang Katipunan nang ilahad niya ang kaibahan ng kalagayan ng kapuluan bago dumating ang mga Espanyol at sa panahon ng pananatili ng mga banyaga sa Pilipinas sa loob ng tatlong daang taon. Mababasa sa sipi ang malinaw na paglalahad ni Bonifacio:

Ytong Katagalugan na pinamamahalaan ng unang panahon ng ating tunay na mga kababayan ... lubos na kasaganaan, at kaguinhawahan. Kasundo niya ang mga kapit bayan at lalung lalo na ang mga taga Japon sila’y kabilihan at kapalitan ng mga kalakal malabis ang pag yabong ng lahat ng pinagkakakitaan.

Sa siping ito makikita ang salitang “Katagalugan” na pangalang ginamit para sa kapuluan at hindi Filipinas, at ang lahat ng mga mamamayan nito ay siya namang tatawaging mga Tagalog. Mahalagang pansinin ang paggamit din ng mga salitang “kasaganaan” at “kaguinhawahan” upang ilarawan ang kalagayan ng mga Pilipino bago dumating ang mga Espanyol. Sinundan ni Bonifacio ang kanyang paglalahad ng maliwanag na nakaraan ng isang madilim na paglalarawan sa panahon ng pananakop. Ang panahon ng pananatili ng mga Espanyol ay nagdulot ng paglaho ng “kaguinhawahan” (kaginhawahan). Ayon kay Bonifacio, taliwas ito sa pangako ni Legaspi kay Sikatuna sa kasunduang pinagtibay ng sandugo. Basahin ang sumusunod na salita ni Bonifacio:

Ngayon wala ng maituturing na kapanatagan sa ating pamayanan, ngayon lagui na guinagambala ang ating katahimikan ng umaalingawngaw na daing at pananbitan buntong hininga at hinagpis ...

Tahasang isiniwalat ni Bonifacio ang katotohanan sa pinagmulan ng kahirapan ng mga Pilipino. Inilarawan sa sanaysay ang paglupig ng mga Espanyol, ang paghihirap at paghihinagpis na dulot ng “tanikala” ng mga banyagang umalipin at sumakop sa mga Pilipino. Dahil dito hinimok ni Bonifacio na buksan ng mga Pilipino ang kanilang ng mga mata at isipan. Ayon kay Bonifacio ang “kaguinhawahan” ay “hindi darating at hindi mangyayari” mula sa mga Espanyol. Aniya:

Ytinuturo ng katuiran, na huag nating sayangin ang panahon sa pagasa sa ipinangakong kaguinhawahan na hindi darating at hindi mangyayari. Ytinuturo ng katuiran ang tayo’y umasa sa ating sarili at huag antain sa iba ang ating kabuhayan

Ang salitang katuiran (katwiran, mula sa salitang-ugat tuwid) ay isa pang mahalagang konseptong ginamit din ni Bonifacio sa “Ang Dapat Mabatid.” Matapos isiwalat ang kasalukuyang kalagayan ng Pilipinas, isa namang panawagan ang kanyang ibinigay sa lahat magkaisa sa pagsulong ng adhikain ng Katipunan. Sa pagtatapos ng sanaysay, matapang ang panawagan ni Bonifacio sa mga Pilipino sa pamamagitan ng sumusunod na salita:

“Kaya! oh mga kababayan! ating idilat ang bulag na kaisipan at kusang igugol sa kagalingan ang ating lakas sa tunay at lubos na pag asa na mag tagumpay sa nilalayong kaguinhawahan ng bayang tinubuan.”

Jesus, Gregoria de. *Mga tala ng aking buhay at mga ulat ng Katipunan*. May paunang salita ni Jose P. Santos. Maynila: Limbagang Fajardo, 1932.

Katangi-tanging primaryang batis ukol sa Himagsikang Pilipino ang *Mga tala ng aking buhay at mga ulat ng Katipunan* ni Gregoria de Jesus. Si Gregoria de Jesus, balo ni Andres Bonifacio, ay tinaguriang Lakambini ng Katipunan at naging tagapagtatag at pangalawang tagapangulo ng sangay ng kababaihan ng Katipunan. Sinulat noong 5 Nobyembre 1928 sa kahilingan ni Jose P. Santos, ang akdang “Mga tala ng aking buhay” ay nalimbag sa wikang Ingles noong 1930 sa publikasyong *Philippine Magazine*, sa salin ni Leandro H. Fernandez, isang Pilipinong historyador, at sa isa pang salin sa Ingles ni Jose P. Bantug sa *The Philippine Herald*. Inilathala rin ang salin nito sa wikang Espanyol sa *The Philippine Free Press* at sa *La Opinion*.

Bilang asawa ni Andres Bonifacio at aktibong kasapi sa Katipunan kasama ang mga kapatid na babae, magulang at asawa ng iba pang Katipunero, ang *Mga tala ng aking buhay* ay paglalahad ng pananaw ng kababaihan sa Katipunan at Himagsikang 1896. Matutunghayan sa sariling talambuhay ni Gregoria de Jesus ang ilang yugto sa kanyang buhay tulad ng kanyang kapanganakan noong 9 Mayo 1875 sa Caloocan, mga magulang, pag-aaral, kabataan at pagusbong pag-iibigan sa edad na labingwalong taong gulang kay Andres Bonifacio. Inilahad din ni Oryang, palayaw ni Gregoria de Jesus, sa “Mga tala ng aking buhay” ang pagpapakasal niya kay Andres sa simbahan at sa isa pang hiwalay na seremonya alinsunod sa Katipunan sa tahanan ni Restituto Javier na sinaksihan ng mga kasapi ng Katipunan.

Bilang Lakambini ng Katipunan, nakisangkot at lumahok sa mga gawain ng Katipunan si Oryang. Matutunghayan sa maikling talambuhay na ito ang mga panganib na sinuong niya sa pag-iingat sa mga dokumento at gamit ng Katipunan at kinailangang magpalipat-lipat ng tirahan upang magtago at umiwas sa pagsubaybay ng awtoridad. Sa mga panahong yaon, isinilang ni Oryang ang sanggol na lalaki ngunit binawian din ng buhay makalipas ng ilang buwan.

Mababanggit din ni Oryang ang kanyang mga karanasan sa panahon ng himagsikan mula sa unang sigaw ng himagsikan hanggang sa kanyang pangalawang pagpapakasal kay Julio Nakpil noong 1898. Nabanggit sa bahaging ito ang ilang personalidad sa himagsikan tulad nina Emilio Aguinaldo, Emilio Jacinto, Macario Sakay at Esperidiona Bonifacio, kapatid ni Andres. Matutunghayan din ang salaysay ng paghihirap ng mga Pilipino sa lumalaban para sa kalayaan at kasarilan. Tulad ng ibang kasapi ng himagsikan, kinailangan din ni Oryang na pag-aaralang gumamit ng mga sandata para lumahok sa mga labanan.

Ilang pangungusap lamang ang inilahad sa “Mga tala sa aking buhay” ukol sa mga naganap sa Cavite: tulad ng “magulong halalan” sa Tejeros dahil sa “katampalasang ginawa ng mga kabig na pinumumunan ni Aguinaldo” (pah 17) hanggang sa pagpatay kay Andres Bonifacio. May hiwalay na salaysay ukol dito si Oryang na sinulat niya sa isang liham para kay Emilio Jacinto (Richardson).

Sa huli binanggit ni Oryang ang kalakaran ng Katipunan ukol sa uri ng pagpaparusa sa mga taong sumuway sa pinag-uutos ng Katipunan. Binigay na halimbawa ang pambabae at pagsusugal. Sa mga kasalanang ito, pinapangaralan ang mga kasapi at tinitiwag sa Katipunan

hanggang hindi nagbabago (sa kaso ng pagsusugal). At para sa kabataan ng panahong iyon, nag-iwan si Oryang mga sampung tagubilin. Isa sa mga tagubiling ito ang sumusunod na titik: “8) Matakot sa kasaysayan pagka’t walang lihim na di nahahayag.”

Mga Tala ng Aking Buhay

*Alay kay G. José P. Santos
na siyang humiling na sulatin
ko ang aking kabuhayan.*

GREGORIA DE JESUS
Balo ni Andres Bonifacio.

Ako’y si Gregoria de Jesus, taong tunay dito sa bayang Kalookan, lalawigan ng Rizal. Isinilang ako ng araw ng Martes, ika 9 ng Mayo ng taong 1875, sa pook na pinagbaunan ng libolibong sandatang ginamit sa himagsikan at pinagdausan din naman ng kasunduan ng mga punong naghimagsik bago lumabas ng bayan, lugar na tinatawag na Daang Baltazar noong araw at ngayo’y P. Zamora, blg. 13. Ang ama ko’y si Nicolas de Jesus, taong tunay din sa bayang ito na ang hanap buhay ay Maestro de Obra ng Catero Carpintero at isa sa naghawak ng ilang tungkulin noong panahon ng kastila, naging teniente segundo, teniente mayor at gobernadorsilyo. Ang ina ko ay si Baltazara Alvarez Francisco na taga bayang Nobeleta, lalawigan ng Kabite, pamangkin ni heneral Mariano Alvarez ng Magdiwang sa Kabite na siyang unang gumalaw ng himagsikan sa nasabing lalawigan.

Ako’y nag-aral sa Paaralang Bayan at natapos ko ang mga unang baytang ng karunungan na katimbang ng Intermedia kung itutulad sa panahong ito. Naaalala ko pa na minsan akong nagwagi sa eksaming ibinigay ng Gobernador Heneral at ng Kura sa bayan na ipinagkaroon ko ng gantingpalang medalyang pilak na may lasong azul bilang pagkilala sa kaunti kong nalalaman. Palibhasa’y tatlo ka-

Noong m̃ga panahong yaon ay lubhang mapang̃anib ang aming kalagayan at palibhasa'y ang m̃ga anak ñg bayan ay inip na sa kanyang pagkagapos ay bumalikwas at nagkaisa na tulad sa isang tao lamang ang lahat kaya't biglang lumaganap ang K. K. K. at gabi gabi ay puno halos ang aming tahanan ñg m̃ga taong duminig sa tinig ñg inang bayan at dito'y kabilang ang tatlong mag-aama na Enrique Pacheco, Cipriano Pacheco, Alfonso Pacheco, Tomas Remigio, Francisco Carreon na pawang kaanib sa Kataastaasang Sanggunian ñg katipunan at m̃ga tao rin namang kasama sa unang sigaw ñg Katipunan, ay halos ang lahat ay madalas na inuumaga sa pagganap ñg tinatawag na "juramento" o panunumpa. Minsan o makalawa isang buwan ay nagkakaroon ñg "junta" ang m̃ga punong tagapagpaganap, dahil dito'y lalong nagkaroon ñg maraming gawain ang limbagang pinamamahalaan ñg Kalihim na Emilio Jacinto kaya't kinailañgan na niya ang pamamahala sa boong maghapon at noon ay ang dinadamit ko halos ay ang m̃ga kasulatan na lubhang mapang̃anib ingatan ñg panahong yaon at labis nang banggitin pa dito kung saan ako ihahantong ñg kapalaran kung madakip sa aking pagiing̃at at gayon din naman sa m̃ga taong nakatala sa kasulatang yaon na pawang anak ñg Pilipinas na umiibig sa kalayaan, sapagka't may m̃ga pangyayaring sa pamamagitan lamang ñg suplong ay maraming buhay ang napuputi. Madalas na kung may dumarating na pahatid sabi na sasalakayin ñg m̃ga Veterana ang tahanan ay kahit anong oras ay agad kung iipunin ang m̃ga papeles, armas at timbre at sa isang iglap ay patatawag ako ñg kiles na hindi ko makuha ang kumain halos sapagkat kadalasang mangyari ito'y katanghalian at a las 8 ñg gabi at inaabot ako ñg hatinggabi sa lansaṅan sakay ñg kiles, nalilibot ang baybayin ñg Tundo at m̃ga lansaṅan ng Binundok upang mailigtas ko lamang ang mapang̃anib na lagay ñg taong bayan. Ñguni't ang dinaramdam ko lamang na madalas na ako'y napatutulong sa ilang kapatid na inaasahan kong magmamalasakit ay hindi naman tumutulong sapagkat kapag naalaman ang

samang parang tunay na magkakapatid na isang tiyan lamang ang pinagbuhatan. Ako'y may anak na walo sa nasabing pangalawang asawa: dalawa ang patay, Juan na at Lucia, ang anim ay buhay, Juan F. Nakpil, Julia Nakpil, Francisca Nakpil, Josefina Nakpil, Mercedes Nakpil, Caridad Nakpil. Ang lahat ng iya'y halos si Dr. Aris-ton Bautista ang nagpaaral at nagpatapos sa anak kung lalaki. Ako'y inaring parang tunay na anak at kapatid hanggang siya'y tawagin sa sinapupunan ni Bathala.

Tungkol sa sigalot ni Bonifacio at ni Aguinaldo na nagmula sa idinaos na magulong halalan sa Teheros, pati ng pag-uusig at mga katampalasanang ginawa ng mga kabig na pinamumunuan ni Aguinaldo sa aming magaanak na niwakasan sa pagpatay kay Andres Bonifacio ay hindi ko na isinaysay dito at iya'y mababasa sa kasulatang ipinadala ko kay Emilio Jacinto na ibinabalita sa akin ng Gral. Cipriano Pacheco na ngayon ay na sa kay G. José P. Santos, (***) at upang maipagpatuloy pa ang aking buong nalalaman sa nasabing katipunan ay minarapat kong pagtiyagaan at ng maunawaan ng lahat na ako ang unang nagtraducir o nagsalin ng aktang "alfabeto" na ipinadala sa akin sa Pasig ni Emilio Jacinto, kasama ang kanyang kapiirasong buto sa hita noong siya'y tamaan ng bala sa pakikilaban sa Nagkarlang, sakop ng Lalaguna ng panahong yaon. Ako naman ay nasa bayang Pasig, lalawigan ngayon ng Rizal. Kaya doon ko rin ginawa o isinalin ang nasabing "alfabeto" o akta ng katipunan.

Gaya rin naman ng unang Limbagan, revolver, sandata, balaraw, timbre at lahat ng kagamitan ay bili ng mataas na sanggunian, nguni't ang ibang handog nina GG. Francisco Castillo at Valeriano, mga taong may malaking damdamin, marunong mag-adiya sa bayang tinubuan, may mahabang hangarin. Kaya't kapagkarakang malaman ang

(**) Mababasang buo sa "*Ang Sigalot ni Bonifacio at ni Aguinaldo*" ni José P. Santos. Ang akdang ito ay nilagyan ng Paunang Salita ni Hen. Artemio Ricarte at kasunod nitong lilimbagin.

nilalayon ng katipunan ay bumili agad ng malaking limbagan upang sa madaling panahon ay makayari agad ng maraming Kartilya, periodiko at mga palatuntunan, kaya noong huli'y pinagtulungtulungan nina Emilio Jacinto, Aguedo del Rosario, Alejandro Santiago, Cipriano at Marciano na taga Pulo, Bulakan, at ang tagapamahagi at tagalakad ay sina Macario Sakay, at iba pang panguluhan. Ang palagay ng ibang siya'y masamang taong naging tulisan ay ewan ng huli, sapagka't nakita ko naman na may malaking ginawang tulong sa Katipunan. Si Macario Sakay ay tunay na makabayan at di ko akalain na ang maging hantungan ay ang bibitayan.

Ilang mahalagang bagay na aking napagdanasan sa panahon ng himagsikan ay itong sumusunod: Nang ako'y kasama ng mga kawal ng naghihimagsik sa parang ng digmaan ay wala akong pangimang sumuong sa anomang kahirapan at sa kamatayan man, sapagka't wala akong nais ng panahong yaon kundi ang mawagayway ang bandila ng kasarinlan ng Pilipinas, at palibhasa'y kasama ako at sumaksi sa maraming laban, kaya't kabilang din akong isa sa mga kawal at upang maging ganap na kawal, ako'y nagsanay ng pagsakay sa kabayo at nag-aral na mamaril at humawak ng ilang uri ng sandata na nagamit ko rin naman sa maraming pagkakataon. Napagdanasan ko rin naman ang matulog sa lupa ng walang kinakain sa boong maghapon, uminom sa mga labok ng maruming tubig o kaya'y katas ng isang uri ng baging sa bundok na tutoong mapakla na nagiging masarap din dahil sa matinding uhaw. Anopa't sa gulang kong tinataglay noon kung pagbabalikan kung alalahanin ngayon, ako sa sarili'y nagtataka kung papano ko natawid ang kabuhayang yaon at kung bakit ako buhay pa sa gitna ng mahigpit na pag-uusig sa akin ng panahong yaon.

Ang natatandaan kong kaparusahan sa hindi sumusunod ng mga ipinaguutos ng katipunan, gaya ng mangtabae, ay ipatatawag kapagkarakang maunawaan sa halip

na siya'y bigyan ng kaparusahan ay agad siyang babasahan ng dapat pagpitaganan ang isang babae, gaya na rin ng pagpipitagan sa sarili na ang sinasabing pangaral ay ganito: "Kung hindi mo gustong lapastanganin ang iyong Ina, asawa at kapatid ay nararapat na pakainġatan mo na gawin mo sa iba ito pagka't sa ganyang kaapihan ay maari mong ipalit ang tatlo mang buhay. Kaya't isa-isip tuwina na ang masama sa iyo ay hindi dapat gawin kailan man sa iba at sa paraang iyan ay isa kayong maraṅgal na maibibilang na anak ng bayan".

Tungkol sa suliraning pagsusugal ay ang marapatan ng tagausig balanġay at mapatotohanang nagkasala, siya'y lalapatan ng hatol na siya'y ihihiwalay hangga't di nagbabago ng kaniyang kaugalian. Lahat naman ng mga nag-sitanggap ng aral at saka ang mga maparusahan ay pangwang nangagsipagbago naman ng ugali.

Sa kahilnġan ni G. José P. Santos na siyang pinagbahandugan ko ng kasaysayang ito ng aking buhay ay itinala ko sa ibaba ang sampung tagubilin o aral sa mga kabataang kinabibilanġan niya na siyang pangwakas nito:

1.—Igalang at mahalín ang magulang pagka't ito ang pangalawang Dios sa lupa.

2.—Alalahanin tuwina ang mga banal na aral ng mga bayani na nasawi dahil sa pag-ibig sa bayan.

3.—Huwag magaksaya ng panahon ng di pamarisan.

4.—Pagsikapang magkaroon ng anomang karunungan na tumutugon sa kanyang hilig upang pakinabangan ng bayan.

5.—Ang kabaitan ay alalahaning isang malaking kayamanan.

6.—Igalang ang mga gurong nagpapamulat ng isip pagka't kung utang sa magulang ang pagiging tao ay utang naman sa nagturo ang pagpapakatao.

7.—Iligtas ang api sa panganib.

8.—Matakot sa kasaysayan pagka't walang lihin na di nahahayag.

9.—Kapag napagingatan ang kasamaan ay door manggagaling ang malaking karanġalan.

10.—Sikapin ang ikapagkakaisa nġ lahat at ikauunlad nġ bayan upang huwag magkaroon nġ sagaba ang kasarinlan.

Tinapos ko rito ang maikling tala nġ aking buhay na sinulat ko sa mġa sandali nġ aking ganap na katahimikan nag-iisang binubulay at pinagaralan at sinuri ang mġa nakaraan kaya't lahat nġ nakatala rito ay siyang mġa waga na katotohanan.

GREGORIA DE JESUS

Kalookan, Rizal
5 nġ Nobyembre nġ 1928

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